Ran LIU （刘然）

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Education

Columbia Business School (CBS), Columbia University, New York, U.S. 2016–2022, 2025–2026

PhD in Finance

Dissertation: *Essays on Informational Efficiency of the Financial Markets*

Committee: Laura Veldkamp (Advisor), Paolo Siconolfi (Chair), Neng Wang, Jane Li, Simon Oh

Centro de Estudios Monetarios y Financieros (CEMFI), Madrid, Spain 2014–2016

MA in Economics and Finance, with Distinction

University of International Business and Economics (UIBE), Beijing, China 2010–2014

BA in Economics (Major: Financial Engineering), with Honors

BA in Management (Minor: Information Management and Information Systems)

Fields of Interest

Asset pricing, information economics, market microstructure, behavioral finance

Working Papers

1. **Market Access and the Production of Information** (Job Market Paper)

- Presented at Columbia (2020, 2021, 2022), CIFFP (2026, scheduled)
- Funded by the Chazen Institute for Global Business and the Bernstein Center for Leadership and Ethics
- **Abstract**: Investors often face restrictions on the assets they may trade. Beyond risk sharing and capital flows, these restrictions can change what investors learn and what prices reveal. In a noisy rational expectations equilibrium model, I study how market access affects information production by reshaping the allocation of scarce data-processing capacity and the aggregation of information through prices. Investors with partial access may acquire information about assets they cannot hold because it helps them value assets they can trade. This cross-asset learning is strongest at intermediate levels of informativeness. Making an asset investable can reduce price informativeness, or increase it while lowering average posterior precision. Calibrating the model to the Chinese stock market, I find large informational effects despite small foreign ownership. Expanding foreign investability has little impact, whereas relaxing the short-sale constraint substantially improves price informativeness.

2. **Reading Tea Leaves: Benefits and Costs of Learning about Future Demand Shocks** (under review at the *Journal of Economic Theory*; available at `https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.7489552`)

- Presented at the AFA Poster Session (2021), FTG Summer School (2019), and Columbia (2018, 2019)
- **Abstract**: In the noisy rational expectations equilibrium (NREE) literature, existing studies have investigated acquisition of information about current demand shocks and current and future dividend innovations. This article fills an important gap by characterizing the equilibrium effects of learning about future demand shocks. It shows that with access to additional information about future demand shocks, investors learn less about current dividend innovations and demand shocks and allocate greater precision to signals about future demand shocks through the front-running channel and a novel *future uncertainty channel*. This future uncertainty channel operates on two levels and breaks the fallacy of composition: at the individual level, acquisition of information about future demand shocks reduces the conditional variance of future excess payoffs; in the aggregate, market-wide dividend information acquisition declines, rendering dividends riskier and raising risk premiums. This article also demonstrates that greater heterogeneity in

private information increases price volatility and that learning about future demand shocks renders prices less informative contemporaneously but more informative in later periods.

3. **From Persistent Disagreement to Agreement: Learning with Revisions of Perceptual Sets**
   - Presented at Columbia (2021)
   - **Abstract**: We often view sensation and perception as one process and mistakenly take our internal representation of the physical world as the world itself. Cognitive biases could occur in the perception process without our noticing. This paper zooms in on the learning process and highlights a specific subprocess—the perception process. Agents take the same sensory information as inputs, direct them through different *perceptual sets* and thus form different *perceptual information*, which is then used to update posterior beliefs. Biased perceptual sets thus lead to persistent disagreement among agents, while *set revision* corrects any perceptual bias and allows agreement to be reached. Depending on the intensity of *perceptual shocks*, agents' sensitivity to perceptual shocks and their initial *entrenchment level*s, there could be overreaction or underreaction in the price to sensory information in the markets. Perceptual revisions can induce rebalancing, while a volume response requires an equilibrium portfolio specification.

Publications in Chinese

Taxation Problems Faced by China's Venture Capital Enterprises and the Solutions, with Xuan Zhou and Yanhong Liu, *Public Finance Research* (《财政研究》), 2012(7).

Conferences and Seminars

Presentations

China International Forum on Finance and Policy (Macau, 2026, scheduled)
CBS PhD Seminar, Free Lunch Seminar and Finance Seminar (Columbia, 2018–2022)
AFA Poster Session (virtual, 2021)
Finance Theory Group Summer School (Wharton, 2019)

Invited Participation

NBER Asset Pricing Program Meeting (Cambridge, virtual, 2021)
New Topics in Banking Conference (Columbia, 2019)

Research Assistantships

Laura Veldkamp, CBS	2018–2022
Enrique Sentana and Dante Amengual, CEMFI	2015
Manxue Qu, Dept. of Finance, UIBE	2013–2014
Yi Fang, Development Research Centre of the State Council of China	2013
Xuan Zhou, Dept. of Management, UIBE	2011–2013

Teaching Assistantships

Doctoral

Economic Analysis IV (PhD), Paolo Siconolfi	SP 2021, SP 2020
Economic Analysis III (PhD), Paolo Siconolfi	SP 2021
Continuous-Time Finance (PhD), Neng Wang	FA 2020, SP/FA 2019
Computing for Business Research (PhD), Daniel Mechanic	FA 2017

Master's

Corporate Finance (EMBA), Roger Mesznik	FA 2021, FA 2019
Game Theory and Business (MBA), Paolo Siconolfi	SP 2021, SP/FA 2020, SP/FA 2019, SP/FA 2018

Game Theory and Business (MBA), Andrea Prat — FA 2019
Advanced Corporate Finance (EMBA/MSc), Roger Mesznik — SP 2021, SP 2020, SP 2019
Advanced Corporate Finance (MSc), John Moon — SU 2019
Advanced Corporate Finance (MSc), Neng Wang — SP 2018
Managerial Economics (EMBA), Andrea Prat — FA 2019

Undergraduate
Money and Banking (UG), Manxue Qu — FA 2012

Scholarships, Fellowships, and Honors

CBS Doctoral Fellowship — 2016–2022
Fundación ICO (Instituto de Crédito Oficial) Scholarships — 2014–2016
Beijing Outstanding Graduate — 2014
UIBE Outstanding Bachelor's Thesis — 2014
National Scholarship of China — 2011, 2013
UIBE Outstanding Student & First-Class Scholarship — 2010–2013
China School of Banking and Finance Yangmei First-Class Scholarship — 2013

Internships

Analyst, Research Dept., Valuebed Capital Co., Shenzhen (remote from Beijing) — 2013
Investment Counselor, China Merchants Securities, Beijing — 2012–2013

Other Training

Mongolian Language, Central Eurasian Studies, Indiana University, Bloomington, U.S. — 2023–2024
Methods Summer Programme, London School of Economics, London, U.K. — 2013

Additional Information

Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent), Mongolian (intermediate), Spanish (intermediate)
Computer skills: C, Python, Bash, LaTeX, SQL, MATLAB, Mathematica, Stata, R, Java
Year of Birth: 1993
Citizenship: Chinese

Academic References

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Franklin Pitcher Johnson Jr. Professor Emeritus
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Dean's Distinguished Chair Professor
Cheung Kong Graduate School of Business
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